

# TCS Placement Prep Brief: 2025–2026

## Academic Year

### Overview

Tata Consultancy Services (TCS) remains one of the world's largest IT services organizations and a primary recruiter for B.Tech graduates in India. As the company pivots toward "AI-First" delivery, its recruitment strategy for the 2025–2026 batch emphasizes strong fundamental coding skills, logical reasoning, and an adaptability to learn emerging technologies like Generative AI and Cloud computing.

### Hiring Process

TCS primarily recruits freshers through the **TCS National Qualifier Test (TCS NQT / TCS iON NQT)**. The process is standardized across on-campus and off-campus drives.

#### Step 1: Online Written Test (NQT):

- **Foundation Section:** Covers quantitative aptitude, verbal ability, and logical reasoning.
- **Advanced Section:** Includes advanced quantitative/logical questions and two coding challenges. *Performance here often determines if a candidate is filtered into the 'Ninja' (Standard) or 'Digital/Prime' (High-salary) roles.*

**Step 2: Technical Interview:** A deep dive into programming logic (C, C++, Java, or Python), Data Structures & Algorithms (DSA), core CS subjects (DBMS, OS, Networking), and a walkthrough of your final year projects.

**Step 3: HR & Managerial Interview:** Focuses on behavioral traits, communication skills, cultural fit, and willingness to relocate.

## Eligibility Criteria

To participate in the 2025–2026 recruitment cycles, candidates must strictly adhere to the following:

- **Eligible Batches:** 2025 and 2026 graduates (B.E./B.Tech, M.E./M.Tech, MCA, M.Sc).
- **Academic Cutoff:** Minimum **60% or 6.0 CGPA** throughout the academic career (10th, 12th, and Graduation).
- **Backlogs:** A maximum of **one active backlog** is permitted at the time of the test, but all backlogs must be cleared before joining.
- **Academic Gap:** An overall gap of no more than **24 months** (2 years) is allowed, and valid reasons must be provided.
- **Age Limit:** Minimum 18 years and maximum 28 years.

## Recent News & Hiring Trends

- **Massive Hiring Targets:** TCS has announced plans to hire approximately **40,000 to 42,000 freshers** for FY25 and FY26. This signals a robust return to campus recruitment after industry-wide slowdowns.
- **Focus on Onboarding:** After a brief pause, TCS has accelerated the onboarding of thousands of new associates in late 2024, ensuring that the 2025–26 cycle remains on schedule.
- **AI Integration:** TCS is currently training its entire workforce in GenAI. New hires are expected to have a "digital-ready" mindset, with training programs ready to pivot freshers into AI and Cloud roles immediately after induction.

## Technical Stack (What to Learn)

TCS values candidates with "Strong Fundamentals + Ability to Learn." While they provide extensive training, proficiency in the following is highly regarded:

- **Languages:** Expert-level comfort in at least one: **Java, Python, or C/C++**.
- **Data Management:** Strong knowledge of **SQL** and relational databases (PL/SQL).
- **Web Technologies:** Familiarity with JavaScript, HTML/CSS, and basics of React or Angular.

- **Core Concepts:** Deep understanding of Object-Oriented Programming (OOPs), SDLC, and REST APIs.
- **Modern Tech:** Foundational knowledge of Cloud (AWS/Azure) and the ability to discuss AI/GenAI use cases.

## Top 5 Preparation Tips

1. **Master One Language End-to-End:** Don't be a "jack of all trades." Pick Java or Python and solve 100+ problems on LeetCode/HackerRank involving arrays, strings, and recursion.
2. **Simulate the NQT Environment:** The NQT is a race against time. Take timed mock tests focusing on the "Foundation" section (Aptitude/Verbal) to ensure you clear the initial cutoff.
3. **Prioritize Coding Efficiency:** In the Advanced NQT section, your code must not only be correct but efficient. Practice medium-level problems on sorting, hashing, and two-pointer techniques to handle large test cases.
4. **Know Your Projects:** Be prepared to explain your project's architecture, your specific role, and the challenges you faced. Use the **STAR (Situation, Task, Action, Result)** method for HR answers.
5. **Audit Your Eligibility:** Ensure your documentation is perfect. Check that your CGPA meets the 60% threshold across all semesters and that any academic gaps are well-documented.

## Sources

- *TCS iON NQT Official Portal:* [tcsion.com/hub/national-qualifier-test/](https://tcsion.com/hub/national-qualifier-test/)
- *Hindustan Times (Business):* [Hiring Trends for 2025-26](#)
- *PrepInsta:* [TCS Recruitment Process Guide](#)
- *Times Now News:* [TCS Hiring Projections FY26](#)
- *GEC Blog:* [TCS 42,000 Fresher Intake Analysis](#)